MATTIAS SEGER

Systemic *Actions*

SYSTEMS THINKING FOR LEADERS · FROM THEORY TO MASTERY

VOLUME IV

The Field Guide

From insight to movement – tools, templates and programmes for leaders and leadership teams.



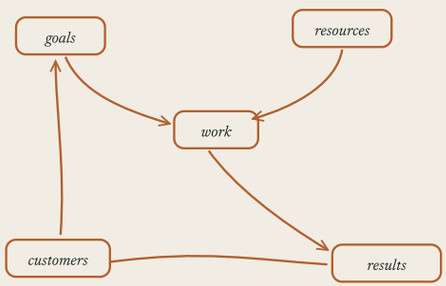
SEE THE SYSTEM · UNDERSTAND THE PATTERNS · UNDERSTAND PEOPLE · CHOOSE THE INTERVENTION · LEAD THE CHANGE · WORKSHOPS AND PROGRAMMES

Draw the System

A system map where you place your own system in the middle and draw in the actors it has relationships with – large and small, near and far, with good and poor relationships.

WHEN	When you want to understand your context, ahead of a reorganisation or a new assignment, or when relationships with other parts of the organisation are chafing.
TIME	90–120 min
PARTICIPANTS	3–12 people, one facilitator · also works individually in 30 min
MATERIAL	One large sheet (at least A1) with the map's four quadrants, round notes in three sizes, pens in red, yellow and green
DIMENSIONS	Team, organisation, environment
SOURCE	Mattias Seger, 2016 · after meta-leadership, Leonard J. Marcus et al. (2006, 2019)
IN THE MAIN WORK	Volume III, Part IX: Draw Your System, p. 468 · Where Does the Boundary Lie?, p. 470 · Volume I, Part I: The Fifth Dimension, p. 56

FIG. FG.6
DRAW THE SYSTEM



boxes, arrows and loops

A system is understood through its relationships. The system map makes the relationships visible on a single sheet. Your own system – the team, the department, the leadership team – is placed in the middle. Around it you draw the other systems and actors it is connected to, in four quadrants. At the top are the **principal** and those who govern: internal on the left, external on the right. At the bottom are the **employee** and those who follow: internal on the left, external on the right. The left side is the **context** inside the organisation, the right side is the **world** outside it.

The map builds on the idea of meta-leadership, developed by Leonard Marcus and his colleagues at Harvard: that leaders need to lead down, up, sideways and beyond their own organisation. I have turned it into a tool to draw with. Three properties carry the map: size, distance and colour.

How it works

1. **Put your system in the middle and draw the boundary (10 min).** Write the name of the system you are looking at in a circle in the middle of the sheet. Be careful about the boundary: is it the leadership team or the whole unit? Test it in three dimensions – which part of the organisation or value chain, which question and which flow – and ask which problems are worth solving and where your resources make the biggest difference. The boundary is temporary; you can move it when the map shows you something new.

2 **Brainstorm the actors (15 min).** List all the systems and actors you have relationships with: managers, the board, other units, support functions, customers, suppliers, authorities, unions, partners, groups affected by what you do. One name per note.

3 **Place them in the quadrants (15 min).** Put each note in the quadrant where it belongs: internal governing, external governing, internal following or external following. Discuss the notes where you disagree – the disagreement says something about the relationship.

4 **Give size (10 min).** Replace the note with a small, medium or large circle according to the actor's importance and influence over your system.

5 **Give distance (10 min).** Move the actor closer to or further from the middle according to how close the relationship is today: how often you talk, how well you know each other.

6 **Give colour (15 min).** Draw a line from the middle to each actor. Red means a poor relationship. Yellow means you talk to each other and the relationship could get better or worse. Green means it is really good. A solid line is a formal relationship, on the line; a dashed line is an informal relationship built on agreements.

7 **Read the map (20 min).** Look at size: do the relationships with the large ones work? Are there small but critical actors with no influence? Look at colour: what needs repairing, what can be developed, what can you use? Look at distance: which key actors need to come closer, and which can be allowed to drift out?

8 **Choose three relationships (10 min).** Choose one red to repair, one yellow to develop and one green to use better. Write down who takes the first step and when.

Facilitator's tips

- Draw the map in pencil or with movable notes first. The first draft is always wrong, and that is fine.
- Let two subgroups each draw a map and then compare. Where the maps differ, the interesting conversations are.
- The "external following" quadrant – those affected by what you do without having any say – is often almost empty. Ask for it explicitly.
- Be careful about putting individual people's names on red lines. Write the role or function, and talk about the relationship, not the person.
- Keep the map. It becomes the basis for the stakeholder maps in the next tool.

What you get out of it

- A shared picture of your context, of which most in the group have only had parts.
- Visible differences between how important the relationships are and how good they are.
- Three concrete relationships to work on, with an owner and a time.

– A starting point for working with the stakeholders systematically.

Common pitfalls

– Drawing only the actors you like or know well. The invisible and uncomfortable ones are needed most on the map.

– Turning the map into an organisation chart. Informal relationships are often more important than formal ones.

– Letting colour become a verdict on others. A red relationship has two ends, and one of them is you.

– Drawing a beautiful map and then doing nothing with it. Step 8 is not optional.

Follow-up questions

– Which actors were hardest to place, and what does that say about our role?

– Which red relationship have we lived with for so long that we have stopped seeing it?

– Who is affected by what we do without ever being present at our meetings?

– What would the map look like if it were drawn by our most important customer – or by our employees?

◇ GO DEEPER IN THE MAIN WORK

Take the questions with you into the volumes – the theory, the cases and the patterns behind the exercise are there.

VOLUME III · PART IX · LEADING LIVING SYSTEMS

Draw Your System p. 468

in the chapter How the System Is Built

VOLUME III · PART IX · LEADING LIVING SYSTEMS

Where Does the Boundary Lie? p. 470

in the chapter How the System Is Built

VOLUME I · PART I · LEADING IN A COMPLEX WORLD

The Fifth Dimension p. 56

in the chapter The Three Capabilities of Leadership

	GOVERNING	FOLLOWING
INTERNAL		
EXTERNAL		

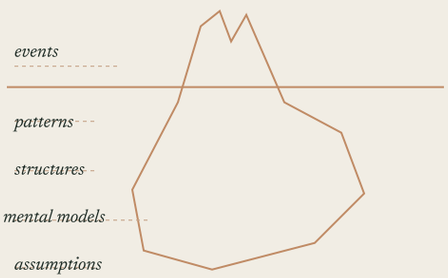
NOTES

The Iceberg in Five Layers

A conversation tool that takes the group from what has just happened down to the assumptions that make it happen again – and so to the places where change actually bites.

WHEN	When the same kind of problem keeps coming back despite fixes, or when the leadership team gets stuck discussing individual events and who was to blame.
TIME	60–90 min
PARTICIPANTS	3–12 people, one facilitator
MATERIAL	Large paper or a whiteboard with an iceberg in five bands, sticky notes in five colours, the template on the next page
DIMENSIONS	self, team, organisation
SOURCE	Mattias Seger, 2025 · after the classic iceberg model in systems thinking (incl. Peter Senge, 1990)
IN THE MAIN WORK	Volume III, Part IX: The Iceberg in Five Layers, p. 452 · Volume II, Part VII: Culture as a Loop, p. 374, and Learning in Two Loops, p. 358

FIG. FG.10
THE ICEBERG IN FIVE LAYERS



dig before you solve

Most of what we call problems are events: a delivery that was late, a key person who left, a budget outcome that fell apart. Events are the tip of the iceberg. Beneath them lie the patterns – what recurs when you lay the events side by side over time. Beneath the patterns lie the structures: rules, roles, incentives, information flows and technology that make the patterns likely. Beneath the structures lie the mental models, the ideas about how things fit together and how they ought to be. I have added a fifth layer at the bottom: the assumptions about what is real at all and how we can know anything. That layer carries all the others.

The tool builds on a simple observation. The further down the iceberg the group gets, the fewer actions are needed – but the more uncomfortable the conversation becomes. Those who only correct events learn in a single loop. Those who reach down to the models and assumptions learn in a double one.

How it works

1. **Choose the event (5 min).** The group agrees on a concrete, recent event that irritates or worries them. Write it at the top of the iceberg with a date. It should be real and delimited, not a general complaint.
2. **Collect more events (10 min).** Each person writes other events of the same kind from the past year on their own notes. Put them up in the first band. Now it shows that this is not a one-off accident.

3 **Look for the pattern (10 min).** Ask: what has happened over and over? Draw a simple curve over time if you like – is it getting better, worse, or moving in waves? Formulate the pattern in one sentence in the second band.

4 **Look for the structures (15 min).** Ask: what in how we are organised makes the pattern appear? Think of goals and measures, decision paths, rewards, resources, information flows, physical and digital systems. Each note should describe something you can point to, not a characteristic of a person.

5 **Dig out the mental models (15 min).** Ask: which beliefs make the structures look the way they do – and make us think they are reasonable? Phrase them as sentences people could actually say: "Control gives quality." "The customer doesn't know what they want."

6 **Reach down to the assumptions (10 min).** Ask: what do we have to believe about the world, about people and about knowledge for the mental models to feel self-evident? This is where it usually goes quiet. Let the silence be.

7 **Choose the level of intervention (10 min).** Go from top to bottom and ask for each band: what could an action here achieve? Choose one action at the structure level and one question at the model level to carry with you.

8 **Close (5 min).** Each participant says one sentence about what they now see that they did not see before.

Facilitator's tips

– Keep the group in each layer. The most common move is to jump straight from event to solution; say kindly "we're not there yet".

– Use different colours of notes for the five layers.

– When the wall is done it is easy to see if the group has got stuck high up.

– In the leadership teams I have worked with, the structure level has often been the hardest, because it is easier to talk about people than about systems. Ask: "If we replaced everyone involved, would the pattern remain?"

– Be careful with the fifth layer. It is not a place for being right, but for seeing that a choice has been made.

What you get out of it

– A shared picture of why the problem keeps returning, instead of a list of who was at fault.

– An action at the structure level, which has a better chance of lasting than yet another action at the event level.

– A formulated mental model the group can test in everyday work.

– A language for asking from now on: "which layer are we talking about now?"

Common pitfalls

– Moralising in the deep layers. Mental models are not wrong thoughts in other people; they are the group's own, and they were often once wise.

– Staying in the pattern band. The group describes trends skilfully but never asks what creates them.

– Choosing too big. An event that holds the whole organisation's history gives an iceberg nobody can work with.

– Leaving without an action. The iceberg is an analysis, not therapy. Something should be tried in everyday work.

Follow-up questions

– Which of our structures remains for a reason that no longer applies?

– Who in the organisation would describe the mental model differently – and why haven't we asked?

– Which event will you notice next week, now that you know which pattern it belongs to?

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VOLUME III · PART IX · LEADING LIVING SYSTEMS

The Iceberg in Five Layers p. 452

in the chapter How the System Moves

VOLUME II · PART VII · THE HUMAN SYSTEM

Culture as a Loop p. 374

in the chapter Forces, Patterns and Assumptions

VOLUME II · PART VII · THE HUMAN SYSTEM

Learning in Two Loops p. 358

in the chapter The Roots of Systems Thinking in Companies and Organisations

EVENTS

PATTERNS AND TRENDS

STRUCTURES

MENTAL MODELS

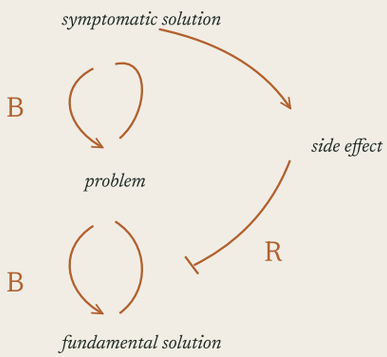
ASSUMPTIONS ABOUT WHAT IS REAL

The Archetype Hunt

A way to recognise the recurring stories in systems – the system archetypes – so that you see the trap before you step into it.

WHEN	When you recognise the feeling of “we’ve been here before”, when a solution has created new problems, or as a follow-up to a first causal diagram.
TIME	90–120 min
PARTICIPANTS	4–16 people in groups of 3–4, one facilitator
MATERIAL	Eight archetype cards (one per archetype, with name, story and a simple diagram), large sheets of paper, sticky notes, the template on the next page
DIMENSIONS	team, organisation, environment
SOURCE	Mattias Seger · after Peter Senge (1990), Donella Meadows (2008) and Garrett Hardin (1968)
IN THE MAIN WORK	Volume III, Part IX: Ten Principles, Ten Traps, p. 494 · Volume II, Part VII: The Rules of the Commons, p. 308, and The Fifth Discipline, p. 354

FIG. FG.13
SHIFTING THE BURDEN



the quick fix takes over

The system archetypes are a small number of structures that recur in entirely different kinds of organisations. Peter Senge collected them in *The Fifth Discipline* (1990), and Donella Meadows described closely related patterns as system traps in *Thinking in Systems* (2008). Each is a combination of reinforcing and balancing loops, often with a delay. Once you have seen them, you recognise them everywhere – in a team, in an industry and in your own life.

The tool works with eight archetypes. **Fixes that fail:** a quick fix relieves the symptom but brings side effects that make the problem worse. **Shifting the burden:** a symptomatic solution takes over and the fundamental solution withers. **Limits to growth:** what drives growth eventually hits a constraint. **The commons:** everyone takes more of a shared resource until it is used up. **Escalation:** two parties answer each other's actions with a little more. **Success to the successful:** whoever gets resources succeeds and therefore gets even more. **Eroding goals:** when the goal is hard to reach, the goal is lowered. **Growth and underinvestment:** you do not invest in capacity until demand has already begun to fall because of the shortage.

How it works

1. **Introduction (10 min).** The facilitator presents the eight archetypes briefly, with an everyday example for each. Stress that they are models – aids for seeing – not diagnoses.

2 **Collect stories (15 min).** Each person writes down two or three situations from their own organisation where something went in a direction nobody wanted. One situation per note, with a few words about how it unfolded over time.

3 **Match them up (20 min).** In groups of three or four, participants place their notes next to the archetype cards. Which story fits which archetype? A story can fit several; that is a good sign, not a mistake.

4 **Draw your own version (20 min).** Each group chooses one story and draws the archetype's loops with their own variables. Mark R and B and mark the delay.

5 **Find the leverage (15 min).** Each archetype has a typical way out: seeing the side effects early, strengthening the fundamental solution, attacking the constraint instead of pushing harder on growth, setting shared rules, seeking an agreement that breaks the escalation, distributing resources by something other than past success, holding on to the goal, investing before the shortage. What does that mean in your story?

6 **Share with the whole group (15 min).** Each group tells its archetype in two minutes. The facilitator listens for archetypes that recur across several groups.

7 **Choose one to watch (10 min).** The group decides which archetype is most active among you right now and which early signs you will look out for.

Facilitator's tips

- Make the archetype cards in advance and keep them short. One story, one diagram, one way out.
- Start with *Fixes that fail* and *Shifting the burden*. Almost everyone recognises them, and they open the way to the others.
- In the leadership teams I have worked with, *Eroding goals* has often been the most charged, because it touches what the group has promised. Give it time.
- The commons is not only about natural resources. A shared budget, shared IT capacity and colleagues' patience work the same way. Also remind people that Elinor Ostrom showed that communities can often manage the commons well when the rules are their own.

What you get out of it

- A shared language for recurring dynamics: "This is shifting the burden again."
- An understanding that the problem lies in the structure and not in anyone's ill will.
- Leverage ideas that have been tried in many organisations before you.
- A watch list of early signs.

Common pitfalls

– Putting on labels instead of understanding. The archetype is the beginning of the conversation, not the end.

– Forcing everything into one archetype. Real situations are often several archetypes working together.

– Using the archetypes against others. “You are engaged in escalation” closes a conversation. “We are in an escalation” opens it.

– Forgetting the delay. Without it, it becomes incomprehensible why wise people walked into the trap.

Follow-up questions

– Which archetype would our competitor – or our owner – say we are in?

– Which of our ongoing initiatives is at risk of becoming the next “fix that fails”?

– Which goal have we lowered without anyone making a decision about it?

◇ GO DEEPER IN THE MAIN WORK

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VOLUME III · PART IX · LEADING LIVING SYSTEMS

Ten Principles, Ten Traps p. 494

in the chapter From Insight to Action

VOLUME II · PART VII · THE HUMAN SYSTEM

The Rules of the Commons p. 308

in the chapter People, Rules and the Network

VOLUME II · PART VII · THE HUMAN SYSTEM

The Fifth Discipline p. 354

in the chapter The Roots of Systems Thinking in Companies and Organisations

ARCHETYPE

OUR STORY

THE LOOPS (R AND B)

THE DELAY

EARLY SIGNS

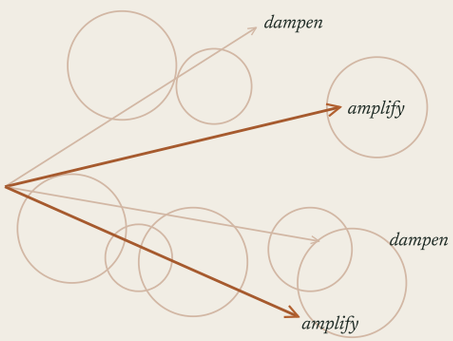
LEVERAGE

The Safe Experiment

The leadership team designs small, reversible trials that are allowed to fail without doing harm – and decides in advance how they will be amplified or dampened.

WHEN	When a question has been placed in the complex domain, when the analysis has stalled, or when the leadership team wants to try an idea without committing the whole organisation.
TIME	60–90 min for design, 20 min follow-up every other week
PARTICIPANTS	3–10 people, one facilitator
MATERIAL	whiteboard, sticky notes, the template on the next page (one per experiment)
DIMENSIONS	self, team, organisation
SOURCE	Mattias Seger · after Dave Snowden (safe-to-fail probes)
IN THE MAIN WORK	Volume III, Part VIII: Complex Adaptive Systems, p. 16 · Volume III, Part IX: Between the Predictable and the Uncertain, p. 488

FIG. FG.31
SAFE EXPERIMENTS



many small trials, read the signals

In the complex domain you cannot analyse your way to the answer, because the answer does not exist until the system has reacted. Dave Snowden calls the trials you then make *safe-to-fail probes*: small interventions designed so that a failure can be borne and learned from. This is something other than a pilot project. A pilot is meant to prove that an already chosen solution works and is rarely allowed to fail. The safe experiment is meant to find out how the system responds, and failure is as valuable as success. Snowden's point is that you need several parallel trials, preferably some pulling in different directions, and that before you start you should know what you will do if it works – how to amplify – and what you will do if it does not – how to dampen. In the leadership teams I have worked with, it is precisely that last question that has changed the most. When the wind-down is decided in advance, it becomes possible to say yes to trials that would otherwise have stayed at a "we should".

How it works

1. **Formulate the challenge as a direction (10 min).** Not "solve the cooperation problem between the departments" but "more cooperation across boundaries in everyday work". The direction says where you want to go, not how.
2. **Sketch many ideas (15 min).** Brainstorm at least eight possible trials. Encourage some that seem naive and some that contradict each other. If all the ideas point the same way, you are only testing one hypothesis.

3 **Choose three to five (10 min).** Choose trials that can be carried out within a few weeks, cost little and can be stopped without lasting harm. Do keep at least one that the group believes in least.

4 **Write the hypothesis (10 min).** For each trial: what do we think will happen, and why? Be concrete about which relationship or loop you are affecting.

5 **Decide amplification and dampening (15 min).** If it works: how do we spread it, give it more resources, make it part of everyday work? If it does not work: how do we end it quickly and with dignity, and who needs to be informed? Write both before you begin.

6 **Set limits and signals (10 min).** What must the trial never put at risk – customers, safety, someone's employment? Which signals say you should amplify, and which that you should dampen?

7 **Appoint owners and start (5 min).** Each trial gets an owner and a date for the first check-in, preferably within two weeks.

8 **Follow up in a fixed rhythm (20 min every other week).** What has happened? What surprised you? Amplify, adjust or dampen. Let the lessons from one trial shape the next.

Facilitator's tips

– A safe experiment should be small enough that someone can say yes today. If it requires a board decision it is not a probe.

- Make it clear that a trial that is ended is not a failure for the person who drove it. Thank people publicly for trials that showed what does not work.
- Keep the experiments small even when they work. Amplification is a decision of its own, not an automatic consequence.
- Let the participants formulate what they would need to see in order to change their mind, before they see the result.

What you get out of it

- A portfolio of small trials instead of one big bet.
- Hypotheses, signals and decision rules that make the learning visible.
- A culture where it is legitimate to try and to stop.
- Knowledge of how the system actually responds – something no analysis could give.

Common pitfalls

- The pilot in disguise. The trial is already decided to succeed, and the dampening strategy exists only on paper.
- A single experiment. Then it becomes a test of a solution, not an inquiry into the system.
- No follow-up. The trials fizzle out, and nobody knows what they learned.
- Too big to be allowed to fail. If a failure harms customers or employees, the trial is not safe, however well it was meant.

Follow-up questions

- Which trial would we run if we knew it was allowed to fail?
- What have we learned about the system – not only about the trial?
- Who in the organisation is already running small experiments that we do not see?
- Which experiment are we afraid will succeed?

◇ GO DEEPER IN THE MAIN WORK

Take the questions with you into the volumes – the theory, the cases and the patterns behind the exercise are there.

VOLUME III · PART VIII · FOUR KINDS OF SYSTEMS

Complex Adaptive Systems p. 16

in the chapter Four Kinds of Systems

VOLUME III · PART IX · LEADING LIVING SYSTEMS

Between the Predictable and the Uncertain p. 488

in the chapter From Insight to Action

EXPERIMENT AND DIRECTION

HYPOTHESIS – WHAT DO WE THINK WILL HAPPEN AND WHY?

AMPLIFY – IF IT WORKS

DAMPEN – IF IT DOES NOT WORK

LIMITS – WHAT WE WILL NOT RISK

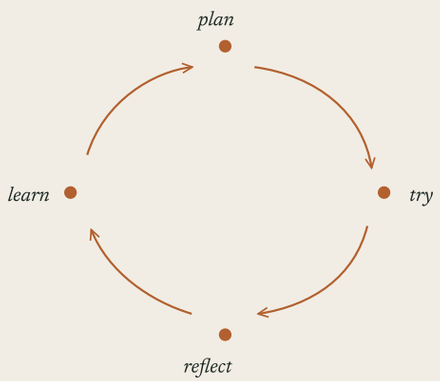
SIGNALS AND NEXT CHECK-IN

The Leadership Team's Learning Cycle

A simple cycle in which the leadership team tries a new way of working, follows it and revisits it every second to fourth week.

WHEN	When the leadership team wants to change something in its own way of working – meeting format, decision process, follow-up – without turning it into a project.
TIME	45 min to start, 20–30 min at each revisit
PARTICIPANTS	One leadership team, 4–12 people; one person holds the cycle
MATERIAL	A learning log (template on the next page), a fixed item on the meeting agenda
DIMENSIONS	Team, organisation
SOURCE	Mattias Seger · after Kolb's experiential learning cycle (1984) and Argyris and Schön's single- and double-loop learning (1978)
IN THE MAIN WORK	Volume II, Part VII: Learning in Two Loops, p. 358 · Volume III, Part IX: Leverage Points, p. 490

FIG. FG.40
THE LEARNING CYCLE



every meeting as practice

Leadership teams often decide to work differently – and notice three months later that nothing has changed. That is rarely because of unwillingness. It is because a new way of working is an intervention in a system, and systems pull back towards their normal state if no one follows up. The learning cycle is a way of keeping a new way of working alive long enough for it to be evaluated.

The cycle builds on a classic idea: learning happens when we do something, reflect on it, draw conclusions and try again. The systemic addition is that the leadership team also asks why things turned out as they did – not only whether the way of working worked, but what the result says about the assumptions the group is working from. That is the difference between adjusting and learning in two loops.

How it works

1. **Choose a way of working (10 min).** Choose one thing, not five. It could be starting every meeting with a check-in, making decisions with a fixed question about which stakeholders are affected, or putting the strategic questions first on the agenda.
2. **Formulate a hypothesis (10 min).** Write in the log: "If we do X we think Y will happen, and we will notice it through Z." Be concrete about the signs. A sign could be that more people speak, that decisions are made in one meeting instead of three, or that employees ask different questions.

3 **Decide rhythm and responsibility (5 min).** Decide when you will revisit, every second to fourth week, and who makes sure it happens. Put the revisits in the calendar straight away.

4 **Try it (2–4 weeks).** Do what you decided. The person responsible briefly notes in the log when something unexpected happens.

5 **Revisit – what happened? (10 min).** Each member says one sentence about what they have seen. Listen first, evaluate afterwards.

6 **Revisit – why? (10 min).** Ask: what in the system made it turn out this way? Which assumption did we have that turned out to hold, or not? The iceberg can help here – is it behaviours, patterns, structures or beliefs that have moved?

7 **Decide (5 min).** Three possibilities: keep, adjust or end. An experiment that ends is not a failure. Write down what you learned.

8 **Next round.** After three or four rounds, or when the way of working has become everyday practice: choose the next thing to try.

Facilitator's tips

– Keep the experiments small and safe to fail with. That makes it easier to tell the truth at the revisit.

– Let responsibility for the cycle rotate around the group. It then becomes the group's cycle, not the manager's.

– Pay attention to delays. Some effects do not show until after two rounds. Do not end too early.

What you get out of it

– A way of changing the leadership team's way of working that does not require big decisions.

– A log that shows what the group has tried, what it has learned and which assumptions have been shaken.

– A habit: seeing your own way of working as something you can experiment with.

Common pitfalls

– Trying too many things at once. Then you cannot know what made the difference.

– Skipping the revisits when the agenda is full. The cycle dies at the first cancelled revisit.

– Only asking "did it work?" and never "what does it say about us?".

Follow-up questions

– Which of our ways of working have we never tried to change – and why?

– Which feedback loop in our own work is the longest – and how can we shorten it?

– Who outside the leadership team could give us feedback on the experiment?

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VOLUME II · PART VII · THE HUMAN SYSTEM

Learning in Two Loops p. 358

in the chapter The Roots of Systems Thinking in Companies and Organisations



VOLUME III · PART IX · LEADING LIVING SYSTEMS

Leverage Points p. 490

in the chapter From Insight to Action

WAY OF WORKING WE ARE TRYING

HYPOTHESIS: IF … THEN … AND WE WILL NOTICE IT THROUGH …

WHAT HAPPENED

WHY – WHICH ASSUMPTION

DECISION: KEEP, ADJUST, END

ABOUT THE AUTHOR

Mattias Seger

Leadership consultant, executive coach and speaker

Mattias Seger has worked for more than twenty years with leaders, leadership teams and organisations in Sweden and internationally – in government agencies, state and public companies, global corporations, sport, culture and smaller businesses. He has coached for more than twenty thousand hours and met more than two thousand managers and leaders, from CEOs and leadership teams to teams across whole organisations.

He has not only stood on the sidelines. In a large government agency he was himself head of transformation and chief architect, and led the shift to a flow-based organisation with the citizen at the centre. He has led global leadership programmes on several continents, followed global companies from functional management to cross-functional work, and supported leadership teams through reorganisations, digital transitions and cultural change.

Since 2012 he has been developing the approach that is today called Systemic Actions: systems thinking for leaders in the real world, from theory to mastery. He is also the creator of Luminus, a framework for leadership, team and organisational development, and the founder of Enterprise Movement. He lives in the Stockholm area and works in Swedish and English.

Leadership sits in the system – and the system can be led.

linkedin.com/in/mattiasseger

BY THE NUMBERS

20+

years with leaders and organisations

20,000+

hours of coaching leaders and leadership teams

2,000+

managers and leaders in programmes and coaching

2012

the year Systemic Actions began to take shape

SELECTED ASSIGNMENTS AND ROLES

2025–	Founder and lead partner, Enterprise Movement
2016–	Founder and developer, Luminus
2014–2017	Head of transformation and chief architect at a large government agency
2012–	Management consultant and transformation coach in global corporations, state and public companies

SYSTEMIC ACTIONS · VOLUME IV

From insight to movement

The Field Guide collects the tools, worksheets and workshop programmes behind the three volumes. Each tool can be used straight away – at the next leadership team meeting, in your team or in your own leadership.

See the system. Understand the patterns. Understand people. Choose the intervention. Lead the change – and learn from what happens.

Mattias Seger is a systems thinker, organisation designer and founder, and has worked with leadership development for more than twenty years.

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